MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS ORGANIZATIONAL MEETING

Approved 2/19/2025

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Un~~approved minutes
January 15, 2025

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m. by Clerk Lori Mott.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America.

COMMISSIONERS PRESENT

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps and members of the public

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the agenda as presented. Clerk Mott asked for discussion, hearing none, **motion carried**.

ELECTION OF CHAIRMAN

Clerk Mott called for nominations for the election of the Board of Commissioners Chairman three times. Commissioner Gilmore and Commissioner Haskell were nominated. It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to vote by secret ballot, **motion carried**. Commissioner Gilmore was elected for the Board of Commissioners Chairman.

ELECTION OF VICE-CHAIRMAN

Chairman Gilmore called for nominations of the Board of Commissioners Vice-Chairman three times. Commissioner Majewski nominated Commissioner Fancon, hearing no other nominations Chairman Gilmore closed nominations, Commissioner Fancon was unanimously elected as Vice-Chairman.

COMMITTEE APPOINTMENTS

Chairman Gilmore passed out committee appointments that he drafted in anticipation of being elected Chairman that will replace the committee assignments made by Commissioner Haskell and announced that the committee appointments will take place at the next Committee of the Whole meeting.

BOARD RULES

It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to update Section 8.2 on page 20 to make it the next general election, **motion carried**.

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to adopt the board rules with the changes recommended by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, **motion carried**.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of December 18, 2024, **motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

A citizen expressed concern regarding leakage from garbage trucks, black substances covering their roof, a GFL truck dropping garbage bags in the street, another truck losing his cargo, apparent spills of black substance in the roadway in their neighborhood and showed photographs of each. Chairman Gilmore replied that the county or township does not have jurisdiction over the landfill and offered the concerned citizen the phone number to the State Representative.

Tom Pirnstill, Executive Director of Clare County Transit, introduced Katie MacInnes as his replacement after his retirement in February, Jeremy Switzer the new Operations Manager and Rachell Ramirez the new Office Manager.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Letter from Gladwin Planning Commission – No discussion
2. Michigan minimum wage and paid leave update – No discussion
3. Letters to attorneys regarding audit – No discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps provided the Commissioners with an update regarding the current Cyber Security Audit that is currently underway, reported that the S&P Global Report was complete and announced that several policies and wages need to be reviewed and changes need to be made.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

Sheriff John Wilson distributed and discussed the Sheriff Department's year end statistics. He gave special recognition to Josh Chapman, Clare County's IT Director, who has been helpful during their recent changeovers.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Community Mental Health
It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to re-appoint Joe Phillips as a Clare County member of the Community Mental Health for Central Michigan Board of Directors for a three-year term to end on March 31, 2028, **motion carried**

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Transit/Michigan Department of Transportation Resolutions
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Resolution of Intent #25-01 to apply for financial assistance for fiscal year 2025-2026 for Clare County public transportation program, Contract Resolution #25-02 for fiscal year 2025-2026 which allows Katie MacInnes, Clare County Transit Director, to execute contracts with MDOT which are $1,081,000.00 or less, Resolution Authorizing Adoption and Ratification of Contract Clauses Certification #25-03 which governs how any transit project requirements apply and such clauses apply to all federally funded contracts for fiscal year 2025-2026 and Resolution #25-04 Authorizing Adoption and Ratification of Public Act 51 to maintain an accessibility plan with MDOT addressing accessibility for all residents, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Hoefling, Housler, Majewski, Gross, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

2. Department of Public Works
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to re-appoint Lester Vida, Brian Tomaski, Luke Potter, Jason Walters and Sam Russell to the Department of Public Works Board for a three-year term to end September 30, 2028, **motion carried.**

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of December 23, 2024 in the amount of $93,963.82 and the meeting minutes of January 6, 2025, in the amount of $57,234.72, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Fancon, Majewski, Housler, Ambrozaitis, Kleinhardt, Gilmore, Haskell, Gross and Hoefling
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to approve the expenditures for the month of December 2024, in the amount of $2,600,762.42 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,425,360.21, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Haskell, Gilmore, Hoefling, Housler, Majewski, Gross, Fancon and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Budget Adjustment #25-31 in the amount of $112,280.83, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Majewski, Fancon, Gross, Gilmore, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

4. Bond Resolution
   Discussion was initiated by Chairman Gilmore on whether the Board should pass a motion to table and have a meeting at the Road Commission so all the Commissioners can be more informed. It was determined that every Commissioner has had the opportunity to visit the Road Commission and waiting would hinder the timeline that Dewayne Rogers, Clare County Road Commission Manager, has already set. The Road Commission Board is already in full support.

   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to adopt Resolution #25-05, authorizing issuance of the County's Limited Tax General Obligation Bonds in the maximum principal amount of $12,000,000.00 to finance Clare County Road Commission facilities improvements and pledging the County's limited tax full faith and credit to repayment of such bonds, roll call revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Housler, Ambrozaitis, Gross, Fancon, Haskell and Majewski
   Nays: (1) being Chairman Gilmore
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

5. MERS
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to exclude all part time employees from retirement benefit eligibility, after discussion roll call revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gross, Gilmore, Haskell, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Hoefling and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott gave an update regarding the reallocation of Circuit Court Family Division cases being moved from Judge Klaus' docket to Judge Hovey and Judge Ambrozaitis' docket, which are handled by the County Clerk's office.

Clerk & Register of Deeds Mott announced that she expects a county wide election in May and noted that the filing deadline is February 11, 2025.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger reported that the 2024 property taxes are being collected at the townships, 2023 property taxes are in forfeiture and the 2022 property taxes will be foreclosed if not paid by March 1, 2025. Her office is working hard to find and call property owners in an effort to help them avoid foreclosure. Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger reminded everyone that the dog license deadline is February 28, 2025.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman Gilmore explained to Dewayne Rogers, Clare County Road Commission Manager, that his vote against adopting Resolution #25-05 is not personal, he voted how his townships wanted him too and expressed his problems with the thirty-year interest rate.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Fancon congratulated Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger and Lori Phelps regarding the S&P Report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Housler has attended her meetings but gave no report.

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings gave a report on each of the meetings he has attended.

Commissioner Gross has attended his meetings and is working on building relationships.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis gave a reminder that the next Airport Committee meeting is January 28, 2025, at 4:00 p.m.

Commissioner Haskell has attended his meetings but gave no report.

Commissioner Kleinhardt had no report, but expressed his concern regarding people struggling to pay their taxes as the number of millages increase.

Commissioner Majewski reported that Lincoln Township has two new cell towers being installed.

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

Administrator Phelps reported ending the fiscal year with a $5.8 million fund balance. There was over $800,000 more in revenue than expenditures, which was more than anticipated.

PUBLIC COMMENT

None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

Meeting Adjourned at 10:14 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners